

Document 9: Anti-Ragging & Student Safety Policy

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

Document Version: 2026.1

Effective Academic Year: 2026-2027

1. Statutory Zero-Tolerance Framework and Legal Compliance

The Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT) maintains an absolute, uncompromising zero-tolerance policy toward any form of ragging, hazing, or student intimidation within its campus boundaries, residential hostels, transport vehicles, and surrounding perimeter zones. In strict compliance with the guidelines set forth by the University Grants Commission (UGC) Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, as well as state-level anti-ragging legislation, the university treats ragging not merely as a campus disciplinary infraction, but as a cognizable criminal offense under the law.

The administration recognizes that the transition from school to professional engineering education can be intimidating for incoming freshmen. Consequently, the institutional safety framework is engineered to dismantle power imbalances between senior and junior batches. The legal definition of ragging enforced at HIT encompasses any display of disorderly conduct, verbal or physical abuse, targeted teasing, forced financial extortion, or psychological humiliation that causes or is likely to cause physical or mental psychological trauma, apprehension, or shame to a fresher or any other student.

Ignorance of these statutory rules by senior students will never be accepted as a valid legal defense by the university administration or by external law enforcement agencies.

2. Comprehensive Categorization of Prohibited Behaviors

To ensure that students, faculty members, and disciplinary committees share a uniform understanding of prohibited acts, the university explicitly categorizes behavioral violations into distinct tiers of severity.

The first category involves Verbal and Psychological Humiliation. This includes forcing junior students to sing songs, recite explicit poetry, strip of clothing, or perform degrading physical exercises under the guise of "ice-breaking" or "introductory sessions." Any form of targeted name-calling, regional discrimination, religious profiling, or derogatory remarks directed at a student's socio-economic background falls immediately under this classification.

The second category covers Physical Violence and Forced Servitude. Requiring freshers to carry the backpacks of senior students, run personal errands, clean hostel rooms, or stand in awkward postures for extended periods constitutes severe hazing. Any physical contact, ranging from playful slapping and pushing to brutal assault, results in immediate criminal categorization.

The third category addresses Modern Digital and Cyber Ragging. With the pervasive use of smartphones and social media, hazing has migrated into digital spaces. Creating anonymous online hate pages targeting junior students, forcing freshers to record degrading confession videos and upload them to Instagram or Snapchat, or sending intimidating WhatsApp messages demanding money or late-night physical appearances are treated with the exact same legal gravity as physical assaults.

3. The Anti-Ragging Committee (ARC) and Anti-Ragging Squad (ARS)

To enforce safety protocols and investigate grievances proactively, the university operates a dual-layered administrative structure consisting of the Anti-Ragging Committee and the Anti-Ragging Squad.

The Anti-Ragging Committee (ARC) is the high-level policy-making and judicial body of the institution. It is chaired directly by the Director of the Institute and includes the Dean of Student Affairs, local civil and police administration representatives, local media personnel, non-governmental organization representatives focused on youth rights, senior faculty members, and parent-student representatives. The ARC is responsible for reviewing institutional safety measures, deploying surveillance resources, and handing down final punitive verdicts on proven ragging cases.

Operating directly under the ARC is the Anti-Ragging Squad (ARS). The ARS is a mobile, tactical intervention unit consisting of senior professors, Chief Wardens, and campus security officers. The ARS is tasked with maintaining active surveillance across vulnerable campus zones, including the hostel dining halls, parking basements, stairwells, and isolated campus perimeters. The squad conducts unannounced, randomized night patrols of the freshman residential blocks (Boys Hostel Block A and the corresponding wings of the Girls Hostel) between the hours of 10:00 PM and 3:00 AM to ensure that senior students are not trespassing or attempting unauthorized interactions with junior cohorts.

4. Mandatory Anti-Ragging Undertakings and Documentation

Legal compliance at HIT begins before a student even steps into a classroom. Every student and their parent or legal guardian must complete a mandatory administrative onboarding ritual regarding anti-ragging policies.

During the physical document verification phase of admission, the candidate and their parent must sign a physical affidavit acknowledging the university's anti-ragging rules and accepting the punitive conditions. Furthermore, in accordance with national digital governance standards, every student must log into the centralized national anti-ragging portal within seventy-two hours of completing their fee payment. They must submit a digital anti-ragging undertaking online and generate a unique reference confirmation number, which must be uploaded to the HIT Student Portal.

Students who fail to submit both the physical affidavit and the digital portal confirmation number before the formal inauguration of classes will have their admission status placed on administrative hold, rendering them unable to register for their semester courses or receive their official student ID cards.

5. 24/7 Emergency Helplines and Rapid Response Protocols

Time is of the essence when a student is facing active harassment or intimidation. The university maintains a multi-channel emergency communication network designed to provide immediate physical intervention.

The institution operates a dedicated, 24-hour Anti-Ragging Toll-Free Helpline managed directly by the Office of the Dean of Student Affairs. This helpline is staffed continuously by trained security personnel capable of dispatching the mobile Anti-Ragging Squad to any location on campus within three minutes of receiving an alert.

In addition to the telephone helpline, students can utilize the "Panic Button" feature embedded within the HIT Mobile Student Portal. Pressing this button for three consecutive seconds automatically transmits the student's real-time GPS coordinates to the central security grid, triggering a silent alarm at the main gate and dispatching the nearest security patrol vehicle to the student's exact geographic location.

Posters displaying these emergency helplines, accompanied by the direct phone numbers of the Chief Warden and local police station, are permanently painted on the walls of every elevator, corridor, and hostel common room. Tampering with, covering, or defacing these safety posters is classified as a direct obstruction of institutional security and carries a severe disciplinary fine.

6. Punitive Penalties and Legal Consequences

When an investigation conducted by the Anti-Ragging Squad confirms that a student has engaged in ragging, the university does not issue preliminary warnings or gentle reprimands. The punitive action is swift, absolute, and legally binding.

Depending on the severity of the offense established during the disciplinary hearing, the Anti-Ragging Committee is empowered to execute one or more of the following statutory penalties:

- **Immediate Suspension from Classes:** The accused student is barred from attending lectures and laboratories for the remainder of the semester, forfeiting all attendance for that period.
- **Expulsion from Hostel Facilities:** The student is permanently evicted from the campus residential blocks with zero refund of room rent or mess fees, and they are barred from applying for hostel housing for the rest of their degree.
- **Withholding of Academic Results:** The university will freeze the student's grade transcripts, denying them the right to write semester examinations or receive backlog clearances.
- **Rustication and Degree Cancellation:** The student is permanently expelled from the Hyderabad Institute of Technology. Their name is stricken from the national higher education registry, and a permanent mark of dismissal for ragging is recorded on their official transfer certificate.
- **Criminal Prosecution:** For physical assaults, severe extortion, or digital cyber-harassment, the university administration files an immediate First Information Report (FIR) with the Cyberabad Police Department, transferring the student directly into judicial custody for criminal prosecution under the state penal code.

7. Bystander Responsibility and Anonymous Reporting

The university recognizes that a culture of silence enables abusive behavior.

Therefore, the anti-ragging policy places a legal and ethical duty of care not only on the perpetrators and victims, but also upon the institutional bystander community.

If a student witnesses an act of ragging—whether in a hostel room, a bus, or a canteen—and chooses to remain silent, pretend not to notice, or actively films the incident on their mobile phone for entertainment, they are classified as an active accomplice to the violation. Bystanders who fail to report hazing to the authorities will face the exact same disciplinary suspension as the primary perpetrators.

To encourage safe, fear-free reporting, the institution provides an Anonymous Whistleblower Drop-Box located outside the Dean's Office, alongside a secure, encrypted digital form on the student portal that does not require a login ID. Students can drop handwritten notes or submit digital tips detailing ongoing hazing activities, specific room numbers, or senior student names without fear of retaliation. The Anti-Ragging Squad investigates all anonymous tips within two hours of receipt, ensuring that student safety remains uncompromised at all times.